

# Daniel J. Singer

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*Updated June 2026*

## Employment / Primary Roles

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### Current

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|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Associate Professor of Philosophy<br>University of Pennsylvania                                  | July 2019 – |
| Associate Professor of Legal Studies & Business Ethics (Secondary)<br>Wharton School of Business | July 2021 – |
| Editor, <i>The Philosopher's Annual</i>                                                          | June 2026 – |

### Past

|                                                                       |                       |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| Consultant, Boston Consulting Group                                   | Aug. 2022 – Aug. 2024 |
| Chair of Undergraduate Philosophy, University of Pennsylvania         | July 2021 – June 2022 |
| Assistant Professor of Philosophy, University of Pennsylvania         | Jan. 2013 – June 2019 |
| Institute for Cross-Disciplinary Engagement Fellow, Dartmouth College | Spring 2018           |

**Specializations:** Philosophy of Work, Philosophy of AI, Epistemology, Ethics

**Add. Interests:** Business Ethics; Social Philosophy; Philosophy of Science

## Education

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### University of Michigan, Ann Arbor

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|---------------------|---------------|
| Ph.D. in Philosophy | December 2012 |
| M.A. in Philosophy  | 2010          |

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| Visiting Student in Philosophy, RSSS, Australian National University | 2010, 2012 |
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### University of Pennsylvania

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------|------|
| B.A. in Logic, Information, and Computation and Philosophy (Honors) | 2008 |
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## Publications

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### Books

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|----------------------------------------|-----------------------|
| <i>What's the Point of Employment?</i> | <i>In development</i> |
|----------------------------------------|-----------------------|

This work-in-progress argues that employment should be seen as a major institution in society, akin to a police force or an educational system. Understood this way, employment stands in need of a justification that's acceptable to owners, managers, and employees alike. The purpose of employment, I argue, is to increase productive efficiency while also providing both pecuniary and non-pecuniary goods to workers. This approach to thinking about employment offers a new conception of the institution while also unifying disparate debates in business, philosophy of work, and business ethics, offering a cohesive framework for understanding topics including the nature of the firm and what makes a job good or meaningful.

**Books (*continued*)**

***Right Belief and True Belief*** 2023  
Oxford University Press, New York

*Right Belief and True Belief* likens work in epistemology about what we should believe to work in normative ethics about what we should do. It uses that analogy to draw out a methodology for epistemology that's centered around the question of what we should believe, and it defends a truth-loving consequentialist answer to that question. In doing so, the book sets the stage for a deeply truth-guided approach to all aspects of epistemology.

**Articles**

**"Employment is a Relationship, Not an Exchange"** *In preparation*

**"Should Employees Have Voice at Work?"** *Under Review*

**"The Future of AI Is Many, Not One"** *Under Review*  
with Garzino Demo  
Preprint available here: [arxiv.org/abs/2603.29075](https://arxiv.org/abs/2603.29075)

**"It's Not Always Wrong to Gaslight Employees"** *Under Review*

**"How Diversity Helps Jury Decisions"** *Forthcoming*  
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger  
in *Agent-Based Modeling for Research on Groups, Networks, and Organizations*, James R. Larson, Corinne Coen (eds.), American Psychological Association

**"'AI slop' hides the conversations we should be having"** 2026  
in *npj Artificial Intelligence* (Nature Portfolio)

**"The Epistemic Advantages of Representative Deliberation"** 2026  
with Berger, Grim, Bramson, Holman, and Jung  
in *PLOS ONE*

**"The Epistemic Role of Diversity in Juries: An Agent-Based Model"** 2024  
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger  
in *Journal of Artificial Societies and Social Simulation*

*Outside academia from August 2022 to August 2024, working for the Boston Consulting Group*

**"Philosophical Considerations of Political Polarization"** 2022  
with Berger, Bramson, Grim, Holman, and Jung  
in *The Political Turn in Analytic Philosophy: Reflections on Social Injustice and Oppressions*, Bordonaba Plou, Fernández Castro, and Ramón Torices (eds.)

- "Epistemic Networks and Polarization"** 2021  
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, and Berger  
in *The Routledge Handbook of Political Epistemology*, Hannon and de Ridder (eds.)
- "Don't Forget Forgetting: The Epistemic Importance of How We Forget"** 2021  
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, Jung, Kovaka, and Berger  
in *Synthese*
- Review of Sanford Goldberg's *To the Best of Our Knowledge*** 2021  
in *Philosophical Review*
- "What Epistemic Reasons are For: Against the Belief–Sandwich Distinction"** 2021  
with Sara Aronowitz  
in *Meaning, Decision, and Norms: Themes from the Work of Allan Gibbard*, Billy Dunaway and David Plunkett (eds.)
- "Computational Philosophy"** 2020  
with Patrick Grim  
Entry in the *Stanford Encyclopedia of Philosophy*
- "Representation in Models of Epistemic Democracy"** 2020  
with Grim, Bramson, Berger, Jung, and Page  
in *Episteme*
- "Demoting Promoting Objections to Epistemic Consequentialism"** 2019  
in *Philosophical Issues*
- "A Multidisciplinary Understanding of Polarization"** 2019  
with Jung, Grim, Bramson, Berger, Holman, and Kovaka  
in *American Psychologist*
- "Diversity, Not Randomness, Trumps Ability"** 2019  
in *Philosophy of Science*
- "Rational Social and Political Polarization"** 2019  
with Bramson, Grim, Holman, Jung, Kovaka, Ranginani, and Berger  
in *Philosophical Studies*
- "Diversity, Ability, and Expertise in Epistemic Communities"** 2019  
with Grim, Bramson, Holman, McGeehan, and Berger  
in *Philosophy of Science*
- "Permissible Epistemic Trade-offs"** 2018  
in *The Australasian Journal of Philosophy*

- "Diversity and Democracy: Agent-based Modeling in Political Philosophy"** 2018  
with Holman, Berger, Grim, and Bramson  
in *Historical Social Research*
- "How to be an Epistemic Consequentialist"** 2018  
in *Philosophical Quarterly*
- "Understanding Polarization: Meanings, Measures, and Model Evaluation"** 2017  
with Grim, Bramson, Berger, Sack, Fisher, and Flocken,  
in *Philosophy of Science*, Vol. 84, No. 1, p. 115-159
- "Disambiguation of Social Polarization Concepts and Measures"** 2016  
with Bramson, Grim, Fisher, Sack, Berger, and Flocken  
in *The Journal of Mathematical Sociology*, Vol. 40, Issue 2, p. 80-111
- "Mind the Is-Ought Gap"** 2015  
in *The Journal of Philosophy*, Volume 112, Issue 4, p. 193-210
- "Germs, Genes, and Memes:  
Function and Fitness Dynamics on Information Networks"** 2015  
with Grim, Fisher, and Reade  
in *Philosophy of Science*, Vol. 82, No. 2, p. 219-243
- "Sleeping Beauty Should be Imprecise"** 2014  
in *Synthese*, Volume 191, Issue 14, p. 3159-3172
- "Scientific Networks on Data Landscapes:  
Question Difficulty, Epistemic Success, and Convergence"** 2013  
with Grim, Fisher, Bramson, Berger, Reade, Flocken, and Sales  
in *Episteme*, Volume 10, Number 4, p. 441-464
- "Philosophical Analysis in Modeling Polarization:  
Notes from a Work in Progress"** 2012  
with Grim, Bramson, Fisher, Flocken, and Berger  
in the APA Newsletter on Philosophy and Computers, Vol. 12, No. 1, p. 7-15  
Updated and reprinted in Youngman and Hadzikadic (Editors), *Complexity and the Human Experience: Modeling Complexity in the Humanities and Social Sciences*, Pan Stanford Press, 2014
- "Polarization and Belief Dynamics in the Black and White Communities:  
An Agent-Based Network Model from the Data"** 2012  
with Grim, Thomas, Reade, Fisher, Reade, Garza, Fryer and Chatman  
in *Artificial Life* 13, p. 186-193

- “Information Dynamics Across Linked Sub-Networks:  
Genes, Germs, and Memes”** 2011  
with Grim, Reade, and Fisher  
in *Proceedings, AAAI Fall Symposium on Complex Systems*
- “What You Believe Travels Differently:  
Information and Infection Dynamics Across Sub-Networks”** 2010  
with Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz  
in *Connections*, Vol. 30, No. 2, p. 50-63
- “Robustness Across the Structure of Sub-Networks:  
The Contrast Between Infection and Information Dynamics”** 2010  
with Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz  
in *Proceedings, AAAI Fall Symposium on Complex Systems*

## Grants, Awards, and Honors

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- Google Research Award for Project on AI Innovation (\$10,000)** 2025
- Penn Mellon Fellow and Provost’s Leadership Academy Participant** 2021
- Dean’s Award for Distinguished Teaching by an Assistant Professor** 2018  
Penn’s School of Arts and Sciences award that recognizes one member  
of the junior faculty who demonstrates unusual promise as an educator
- Price Lab for the Digital Humanities Mellon Faculty Fellow** 2016 – 2018
- SCEW (MindCORE) Grant for Agent-Based Modeling Workshop (\$6K)** Spring 2020
- GPPC Conference Grants for PeRFECt (\$3K, \$2K, \$3K, \$2.5K, \$1K)** 2014 – 2019
- SAS Conference Support Grants (\$3K, \$3K, \$2K, \$3K)** Spring 2015, 2017, 2018, 2020
- University Research Foundation Grants (\$2,000, \$2,000, \$2,000)** Spring 2015, 2017, 2020
- SAS Research Opportunity Grant (\$3,000)** Spring 2017
- University Research and Dean’s Grants for PRPSEW (\$4,900, \$5,000)** Spring 2014, 2017
- Penn Provost Excellence through Diversity Grant for PeRFECt2 (\$4,000)** Fall 2016
- Penn Undergraduate Research Mentorship (PURM) Grant (\$5,300)** Summer 2016
- Penn Digital Humanities Forum Project Incubation Grant (\$3,000)** Summer 2015

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| <b>Rackham International Research Grant</b>                                                                                                                                 | <i>Summer 2012</i>      |
| <b>Wirt and Mary Cornwell Prize Fellowship</b><br>Prize for outstanding intellectual curiosity and exceptional promise<br>of original study and creative work in Philosophy | <i>2011-2012</i>        |
| <b>Rackham Graduate School Research Grant</b>                                                                                                                               | <i>Summer 2010</i>      |
| <b>Rackham Graduate School Travel Grants</b>                                                                                                                                | <i>2009, 2010, 2012</i> |
| <b>Marshall M. Weinberg Summer Fellowship</b><br>Prize for academic distinction during early years of graduate study                                                        | <i>Summer 2009</i>      |
| <b>University of Michigan Philosophy Department Fellowship</b>                                                                                                              | <i>2009, 2010, 2011</i> |
| <b>University of Michigan Summer Research Grant</b>                                                                                                                         | <i>2009, 2010, 2011</i> |

## **Selected Presentations and Conference Organization**

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| <b>The Future of AI is Many, Not One</b><br>Presented at Hong Kong University                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <i>March 2026</i>                       |
| <b>What's the Point of Employment?</b><br>Presented at Denison University<br>Presented at Hong Kong University                                                                                                                                                                                                | <i>March 2026</i><br><i>March 2026</i>  |
| <b>Managerial (Over)control and Why It Matters for Firms and Employees</b><br>Presented at PPE Society Conference, New Orleans                                                                                                                                                                                | <i>November 2025</i>                    |
| <b>It's Not Always Wrong to Gaslight Employees</b><br>Presented at Work and Democracy Workshop, Groningen<br>Presented at PPE Society Conference, London                                                                                                                                                      | <i>October 2025</i><br><i>July 2025</i> |
| <b>The Employment Tax on Agency and Managerial Gaslighting</b><br>Presented at University of North Carolina, Chapel Hill                                                                                                                                                                                      | <i>March 2025</i>                       |
| <b>Philosopher Meets Critics: <i>Right Belief and True Belief</i></b><br>Online discussion with Ram Neta, Amy Flowerree, and Kate Nolfi<br>Hosted by CONCEPT (University of Cologne) & Federal University of Bahia<br>Available online at <a href="http://youtu.be/sGb4FZNI0o">http://youtu.be/sGb4FZNI0o</a> | <i>Nov. 2024</i>                        |

**Author Meets Critics: *Right Belief and True Belief***

Discussion with Ram Neta, Amy Flowerree, and Kate Nolfi  
Presented at the Eastern APA in New York

*Jan. 2024***How Management Affects Diversity**

Presented at Boston Consulting Group

*May 2024***Psychological Safety Levels the Playing Field for Employees**

Presented at Boston Consulting Group

*May 2023***Modelling the Epistemic Effects of Diversity and Enclaves**

Presented at Hong Kong University

*April 2022***The Epistemic Role of Diversity in Juries**

Presented at Wharton School of Business

*May 2021***Should Juries be Unanimous?**

Presented at University of Southern California

*September 2020***Jury Unanimity: An Agent-Based Model Approach**

Presented at Social (Distance) Epistemology Workshop

*May 2020*

Presented at University of Pennsylvania

*September 2019***Agent-Based Models of *Is* and *Ought***

Keynote at “ABMs of Scientific Inquiry,” Bochum, Germany

*March 2019***Knowledge for Epistemic Consequentialists**

Presented at Fordham University

*October 2018***Models and Target Systems in Normative Inquiry**

Presented at Hebrew University’s “Modeling Reality Workshop”

*July 2018***Rational Polarization and the Importance of Group ‘Forgets’**

Presented at Dartmouth College

*April 2018*

Publicly Accessible Version Presented at Dartmouth ICE

*May 2018***Epistemic Consequentialism**

Presented at the University of Vermont

*May 2018***Penn Reasons and Foundations in Epistemology Conference (PeRFECT)***2015 – 2018*

Organizer with Errol Lord and Lisa Miracchi

**Permissible Epistemic Trade-offs**

Presented at Chapel Hill Normativity Workshop

*March 2018*

**Rational Polarization and the Importance of Forgetting**

Presented at Dept. of Legal Studies and Business Ethics, Wharton

*February 2018***Group Polarization as a Limitedly Rational Response to Evidence**

Presented at Price Lab for the Digital Humanities, Penn

*October 2017*

Presented at Decisions, Games and Logic, University of Michigan

*July 2016***Models of Group Deliberation: Thick and Thin**

Keynote at DebateLab Workshop on Argumentation in Opinion Dynamics,

KIT, Karlsruhe, Germany

*June 2017*

Presented at DiMiNet, Annenberg School of Communication

*October 2017***Penn-Rutgers-Princeton Social Epistemology Workshop***2013-2017*

Lead Organizer, Spring 2014, Spring 2017

Organizer, Spring 2013, Spring 2015, Spring 2016

**Sophisticated Epistemic Consequentialism**

Presented at Dartmouth

*January 2016*

Presented at Institut Jean Nicod, Paris FR

*June 2016*

Presented at the University of British Columbia

*November 2016***Normative and Scientific Explanation**

Presented at the Eastern APA in Washington DC

*January 2016*

Presented at the Ethics and Explanation Conference, Nottingham UK

*February 2016***Votes, Talk, and Groups: Modeling Epistemic Democracy and Polarization**

Presented at Sawyer Seminar on Trust, Northwestern University

*May 2015***Symposium: Computer Simulations in Philosophical Research**

Presented at the Eastern APA in Philadelphia, PA

*December 2014***Why Believe the Truth**

Presented as a PhilSoc at the Australian National University

*July 2012*

Presented at the USC/UCLA Graduate Conference

*March 2012*

Presented at the Yale/UConn Graduate Conference

*April 2012***Modeling Peer Disagreement**

Presented at the Australasian Association of Philosophy Meeting

*June 2012***Grounding Epistemology in Belief**

Presented at the University of Pennsylvania

*April 2012*

**Information Dynamics Across Sub-networks:****Germes, Genes, and Memes**

With Grim, Fisher, and Reade

Presented at the AAAI Fall Symposium Series

*November 2011***The Is-Ought Gap Gap**

Presented at the Michigan Graduate Student Working Group

*December 2010***Robustness Across the Structure of Sub-Networks:****The Contrast Between Infection and Information Dynamics**

With Grim, Reade, Fisher, and Majewicz

Presented at the AAAI Fall Symposium Series

*November 2010***Some Problems for Imprecise Bayesianism**

Presented at the Australasian Association of Philosophy Conference

*July 2010***Epistemic Conservatism for Imprecise Partial Belief**

Presented at the Notre Dame/Northwestern Epistemology Conference

*March 2010*

Presented at the Princeton-Rutgers Graduate Conference

*April 2010***On James Harrington's "Instants and Instantaneous Velocity"**

Comments presented at the Eastern APA Symposium

*December 2009***On the Use of Isomorphisms in an Account of Similarity**

Presented at the Formal Methods in Philosophy Conference, Penn

*May 2008***Selected Professional and Academic Service**

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**Editor, *The Philosopher's Annual****2026 – Present***Chair of Graduate Admissions, Penn Philosophy***2024 – Present***Member, Penn Presidential Commission on Open Expression***2024 – 2025***Undergraduate Chair, Penn Philosophy***2021 – 2022***Penn Arts and Sciences Curriculum Committee**

Chair

*2019 – 2022*

Member

*2018 – 2022***Penn Arts and Sciences Committee to Revise Curricular Review**

Chair

*2019 – 2021*

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| <b>Penn Arts and Sciences Committee on Undergraduate Education</b><br>Ex-Officio Member                                                                                                                              | 2019 – 2022                |
| <b>Penn Faculty Senate Executive Committee Member</b><br>Representative from Philosophy and Linguistics<br>Assistant Professor Representative                                                                        | 2018 – 2022<br>2015 – 2017 |
| <b>Representative to Greater Phila. Philosophy Consortium</b>                                                                                                                                                        | 2019 – 2021                |
| <b>Placement Director, Penn Philosophy</b>                                                                                                                                                                           | 2013 – 2020                |
| <b>Penn Fraternity and Sorority Advisory Board</b>                                                                                                                                                                   | 2018 – 2019                |
| <b>Steering Committee, Social Epistemology Network</b>                                                                                                                                                               | 2017 – Present             |
| <b>SAS Planning Group on Quantitative Explorations of Evolving Systems</b>                                                                                                                                           | 2015 – 2018                |
| <b>Residential Faculty Fellow, Ware College House</b>                                                                                                                                                                | 2014 – 2018                |
| <b>Phi Beta Kappa Election Committee</b>                                                                                                                                                                             | 2015 – 2017                |
| <b>NEH Institute - Computer Simulations in the Humanities</b><br>Experienced Modelling Mentor at the NEH Institute for Advanced Topics<br>in the Digital Humanities at the University of North Carolina at Charlotte | June 2011                  |

## Teaching

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### As Primary Instructor

|                                                                |                                                                  |
|----------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Introduction to Mathematical Logic (Grad and Undergrad)        | <i>Spr. '26, '25, '20, '15</i>                                   |
| Graduate Seminar on Philosophy of Work                         | <i>Spring '26</i>                                                |
| Knowledge and Reality                                          | <i>F '25, F '24, F '22, F '19, F '18, Spr. '16, F '14, F '13</i> |
| Undergrad Seminar on AI in Work, School, and Research          | <i>Fall '25</i>                                                  |
| Business Ethics & Social Responsibility (Wharton)              | <i>Spring '25</i>                                                |
| Graduate Seminar on Meaningful Work                            | <i>Spring '25</i>                                                |
| Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Architectures                    | <i>Fall '24</i>                                                  |
| Graduate Seminar on the Value of Diversity                     | <i>Fall '22</i>                                                  |
| Introduction to Philosophy                                     | <i>Fall '21, Spr. '19, Fall '17, Fall '15, Spr. '14</i>          |
| Dissertation Writing Workshop                                  | <i>Fall '21, Fall '17, Fall '13</i>                              |
| Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Normativity and Consequentialism | <i>Spring '21</i>                                                |
| Graduate Seminar on Legal Epistemology                         | <i>Spring '20</i>                                                |
| Food and Fat (Seminar on Ethics of Obesity)                    | <i>Fall '19, Spring '16</i>                                      |
| Scientific Reasoning (Undergrad Online)                        | <i>Fall '19, Spring '20</i>                                      |
| Graduate Seminar on the Domain of Epistemology                 | <i>Spring '19</i>                                                |
| Graduate Proseminar                                            | <i>Fall '18, '15, '14</i>                                        |

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|------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Graduate Seminar on Normativity in Formal Epistemology           | <i>Fall '17</i>   |
| Graduate Seminar on Social Epistemology                          | <i>Spring '17</i> |
| Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Reasons                            | <i>Spring '15</i> |
| Graduate Seminar on Epistemic Normativity                        | <i>Spring '14</i> |
| Graduate Seminar on Williamson's <i>Knowledge and its Limits</i> | <i>Spring '13</i> |
| Epistemology (Undergraduate Introduction)                        | <i>Spring '13</i> |
| Problems of Philosophy                                           | <i>Spring '12</i> |
| Introduction to Logic (with Online Component)                    | <i>Summer '11</i> |

**University of Michigan Graduate Teacher Certificate** 2012

Teaching and professional development, including courses and research on teaching, class feedback sessions and evaluations, and a teaching mentorship.

**As Graduate Student Instructor**

|                                               |                   |
|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Philosophy of Mind and Language, Eric Swanson | <i>Spring '11</i> |
| Applied Ethics, Sarah Buss                    | <i>Spring '10</i> |
| Mathematical Logic, Richmond Thomason         | <i>Fall '09</i>   |

**As Teaching Intern and Grader**

|                                        |                               |
|----------------------------------------|-------------------------------|
| Mathematical Logic, David Baker        | <i>Fall '08, Spring '09</i>   |
| Introduction to Logic, Scott Weinstein | <i>Spring '07, Spring '08</i> |